

How It Works

Hangman and Guillotine share the same game mechanics but have different presentations. This makes it easy to swap out the ASCII-art noose graphics with the ASCII-art guillotine graphics without having to change the main logic that the program follows. This separation of the presentation and logic parts of the program makes it easier to update with new features or different designs. In professional software development, this strategy is an example of a *software design pattern* or *software architecture*, which concerns itself with how to structure your programs for easy understanding and modification. This is mainly useful in large software applications, but you can also apply these principles to smaller projects.

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1. """Hangman, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. Guess the letters to a secret word before the hangman is drawn.
3. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
4. Tags: large, game, word, puzzle"""
5.
6. # A version of this game is featured in the book "Invent Your Own
7. # Computer Games with Python" https://nostarch.com/inventwithpython
8.
9. import random, sys
10.
11. # Set up the constants:
12. # (!) Try adding or changing the strings in HANGMAN_PICS to make a
13. # guillotine instead of a gallows.
14. HANGMAN_PICS = [r"""
15.  +--+
16.  |  |
17.  |  |
18.  |  |
19.  |  |
20.  |  |
21.  ==== "",
22.  r"""
23.  +--+
24.  |  |
25.  0  |
26.  |  |
27.  |  |
28.  |  |
29.  ==== "",
30.  r"""
31.  +--+
32.  |  |
33.  0  |
34.  |  |
35.  |  |
36.  |  |
37.  ==== "",
38.  r"""
39.  +--+
40.  |  |
41.  0  |
```